

WHO IS THE THEOTOKOS?

SESSION 00.4 HANDOUT

NAME _____ DATE _____

✦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

This is the song the Theotokos herself sang when she went to visit her cousin Elizabeth, after the angel Gabriel told her she would bear the Son of God. The Orthodox Church sings it every morning at Matins. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

My soul magnifies the Lord, and my spirit has rejoiced in God my Savior. For He has regarded the lowly state of His maidservant; for behold, henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. — Luke 1:46–48

✦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

- | | | |
|--------------|---|---|
| THEOTOKOS | • | • A title for Mary that means she remained a virgin her whole life. The Orthodox Church teaches that she was a virgin before, during, and after Jesus' birth. |
| EVER-VIRGIN | • | • The moment when the angel Gabriel came to (Aeiparthenos) Mary and told her she would bear the Son of God — and she said <i>let it be</i> . |
| ANNUNCIATION | • | • Greek for <i>God-bearer</i> — the woman who gave birth to God. Mary did not just give birth to a man; she gave birth to God Himself, made flesh. |
| NEW EVE | • | • A title for Mary. Eve said <i>no</i> to God and brought death; Mary said <i>yes</i> to God and brought life. Her <i>yes</i> untied the knot Eve's <i>no</i> tied. |

✦ TIMELINE — FIVE MOMENTS IN HER LIFE

Use the word bank to fill in each blank. **Word bank:** *Her Nativity · Annunciation · Christ's Nativity · Crucifixion · Dormition*

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENED
_____	She was born to St. Joachim and St. Anna (celebrated September 8).
_____	The angel Gabriel announced she would bear the Son of God.
_____	She gave birth to Christ in a cave outside Bethlehem.
_____	She stood at the foot of the Cross. Christ gave her to John as Mother.
_____	She fell asleep, and her Son carried her home (celebrated August 15).

✦ SKETCH — DRAW THE THEOTOKOS PLATYTERA

Find the icon of the Theotokos behind the altar at SJTD — she is shown with her hands raised in prayer and the infant Christ in a circle on her chest. This is the *Platytera* — *More Spacious than the Heavens*. Draw a simple version below.

- The **Theotokos** standing with her **arms raised** in prayer
- A **circle** on her chest
- Inside the circle, **the infant Christ** blessing with His right hand
- The letters **MP ΘY** beside her head
- The letters **IC XC** beside His head



✦ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

The lesson ended with the words *she is your Mother now*. Christ gave her to you on the Cross — *behold thy mother* — and the Orthodox Church has always understood He was speaking to every Christian, including you. Write 3 to 5 sentences. Did this land for you, or did it feel strange? What does it mean to you to have her as your Mother — alongside your own mom? *It's okay if you can't put it all into words yet. It's okay to write that it feels strange.*
